Practical 4



Medical and Surgical Asepsis

4.1 Aseptic Techniques

Aseptic techniques is the effort to keep a client as free from hospital micro-organisms as possible.

Principles of Asepsis

Three things that are extremely important is achieving asepsis are the reduction of time, trauma and trash.

1. Time: The time taken for any medical or surgical procedure is an important factor. Longer the time taken, have the possibility or greater exposure to contamination.
2. Trauma: Trauma occurred due to rough handling, excessive dead space, foreign bodies will contribute to infection.
3. Trash If refers to contamination by bacteria or foreign matter.

Essential Components of Maintaining Asepsis In a Hospital Include:

1. Hand washing, 2) Utilizing gloves, gown and mask as indicated 3) cleaning equipment, 4) Proper Handling of linens is the ways to prevent the spread of germs.

Types of Asepsis

The two types of aseptic techniques that the nurse practices are medical and surgical asepsis.

Medical asepsis: It is a clean technique which includes procedure used to reduce the microorganisms prevent their spread. Eg. Changing patient's bed linen daily, hand washing.

Surgical asepsis: It is a sterile technique which includes procedures used to eliminate the microorganism. Sterile technique is used where sterile instruments are used. Eg . In operation theatre.

Medical asepsis: Medical asepsis is commonly referred as clean technique. The goal is to reduce the number of pathogens or prevent the transmission of pathogens from one person to another. Techniques used should be appropriate to interrupt the spread of the known pathogen.

HAND WASHING AND SCRUBBING TECHNIQUE

4.2 Hand Washing

Definition

A technique of cleaning hands developed to prevent transmission of microorganisms

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